Perimeter

Exam code: 0607

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Perimeter

What is perimeter?

- Perimeter is the **total distance** around the **outside** of a 2D shape
  - The perimeter of a **circle** is called the **circumference**
- Perimeter is a length in **one dimension**
  - **Units of measure** include mm, cm, m etc

How do I find the perimeter of a 2D shape?

- **Add together** the **lengths** of all of the sides of the shape
- For any **regular** 2D shape, the perimeter will be the **number of sides**, multiplied by the **length of one side**
  - For example, the perimeter of a square of side length x cm will be $4x$ cm

How do I find the perimeter of a compound shape?

- Shapes may be made up of two or more 2D shapes, these are called **compound shapes**
  - Compound shapes can usually be split into **rectangles**, **triangles** and **parts of circles**
  - You will need to be confident with the **properties of 2D shapes**
    - For example, the distance between the **centre point** of a **circle** and a point on the **circumference** is its **radius**
  - Look out for **sides** that are **equal**, for example in a rectangle, parallelogram, or isosceles triangle
    - **Dashes** may be used to mark the **equal sides**, or the question may tell you which sides are equal
  - You may need to use certain **formulas** to calculate lengths
    - For example, you may need to use **Pythagoras' theorem** to calculate a length on a **right-angled triangle**
  - You may need to use the **given information** to find the lengths of some of the sides

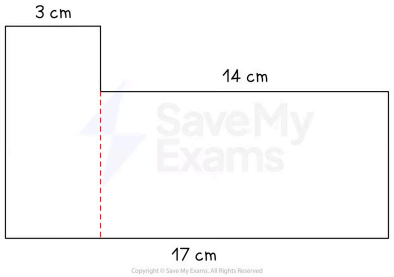
Help me understand

Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it

be the same as the length of the **longer side opposite**

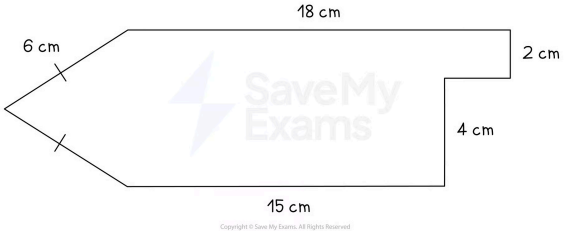


Examiner Tips and Tricks

Understanding properties of different 2D shapes can be essential for missing lengths.

Worked Example

Find the perimeter of the compound shape.



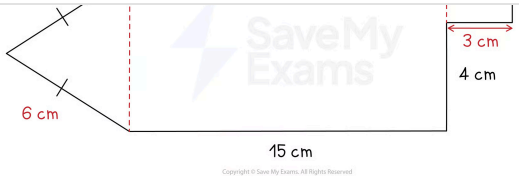
Answer:

The shape can be split up into a triangle and two rectangles

The dashes on the triangle mean that the lengths are equal

Therefore, the missing length is 6 cm

The horizontal lengths of the two rectangles add up to the length of the longest horizontal line
15 cm and the missing length, are equal to the 18 cm length at the top
The missing horizontal length is therefore 3 cm



You can now find the sum of all the sides to find the total perimeter

$$6 + 6 + 18 + 2 + 3 + 4 + 15$$

54 cm

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